

The decline

BlackBerry is still one of the top 5 smartphone OS makers in the world, however, market shares (based on new sales) have gotten a little depressing for them. Considering Apple (iOS) and Android sales, that's about 90 per cent of the market accounted for. Used to be a time you couldn't really ignore BlackBerry when you talked smartphones, because it held as much as 20 per cent market share, this is now down to under 5 per cent, and to be honest, a lot of mobile app developers feel that it's not worth the trouble to re-design apps for 10 per cent of the consumer base (BlackBerry, Windows and others).

What this basically works out to is fewer users because there are fewer apps, fewer apps because there are fewer developers focussing on it, and fewer developers because there are fewer users. Sort of like chicken and egg conundrum. Honestly, our advice to developers is to develop for all platforms; not only does it level the playing field for platform wars (which benefit us end users greatly), it's also easier to get noticed for a good app and make money in a smaller pool, than it is to be spotted in the ocean of apps that are available for Android and iOS.

BlackBerry hopes that their new OS 10 will stop the rot, and turn things around for them. Embracing the touch-world now, they are finally competi-



The inspiration for the keys and the name BlackBerry come from the fruit